

RECENT

Culver City, 1927

The Lost Reel

The last surviving print of *London After Midnight* sits in the MGM nitrate vault — the most famous lost film ever made. In our timeline it burns in the 1965 vault fire; reach it first and it never has to.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Trace the surviving print through the studio vault ledgers

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Reach the nitrate vault before the fire takes hold

Grit 1

FIND

3

Spool the fragile reel onto a safe carrier as the heat rises

Craft 2

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Engineer

Find (step 2): Sell → 3¢ · Publish → 1 rep

RECENT

Príncipe, 1919

The Eddington Plates

Eddington's eclipse expedition is about to photograph starlight bending around the sun and prove Einstein right — if the clouds break. There is nothing to take here, only the plates to record before the weather closes in.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Work the exposure times from the expedition notes

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Hold the camp steady as the clouds close in

Grit 1

FIND

3

Capture the star-shift on the plates at totality

Insight 2

OBJECTIVE

Physicist

Find (step 2): Sell → 3¢ · Publish → 1 rep

RECENT

Nikumaroro, 1937

Amelia's Last Signal

Earhart's final radio calls trail off somewhere over the Pacific. A castaway camp on a coral atoll holds the answer to a mystery the record never solved — document it, and let history keep its bones.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Piece together the flight's last bearings

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Search the atoll's far shore

Grit 1

FIND

3

Document the castaway camp

Insight 1

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 2): Sell → 3¢ · Publish → 1 rep

RECENT

Königsberg, 1945

The Amber Room Panels

The Amber Room is crated in the castle cellars as the front collapses around the city. It vanishes from history this winter. You can copy and measure it — or crate the panels yourself, and let the gap in the record be yours t...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the panels among the castle cellars

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

+1¢ spoil

2

Move through the collapsing city

Grit 1

FIND

3

Work the amber panels loose

Craft 1

OBJECTIVE

Engineer

Find (step 2): Sell → 3¢ · Publish → 1 rep

RECENT

Lincoln County, 1947

The Roswell Fragment

A debris field of foil that unfolds back to flat after you crush it lies under a military cordon for the few hours before the clean-up. Whatever it is, no metallurgist alive can explain it. Study its behaviour — or pocket a piece.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Read the recovery reports before the cordon tightens

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Slip the military cordon

Grit 1

FIND

3

Study the foil's impossible behaviour

Insight 1

OBJECTIVE

Physicist

Find (step 2): Sell → 3¢ · Publish → 1 rep

MODERN

London, 1858

The Great Stink

Bazalgette's prototype relief valve was cast at the Deptford works weeks before the official design was filed. Recover it before the record catches up — and decide whether the world should ever know it existed.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Decipher the unpublished schematics

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Slip into the half-built pumping works

Grit 1

FIND

3

Free the prototype valve from its setting

Craft 2

OBJECTIVE

Engineer

Find (step 2): Sell → 4¢ · Publish → 1 rep

MODERN

London, 1871

Babbage's Lost Cards

In the cluttered Dorset Street workshop, the punched-card programs for the Analytical Engine sit days from being scattered and lost forever after Babbage's death. The first software ever written — and history is about t...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the card-programs in the cluttered workshop

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Reach the workshop before the clear-out

Grit 1

FIND

3

Box up the punched cards before they're scattered

Craft 2

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Engineer

Find (step 2): Sell → 4¢ · Publish → 1 rep

MODERN

King William Island, 1848

The Franklin Log

The *Erebus* is abandoned in the pack ice and her crew are dying on the march south. The ship's log — the whole record of what went wrong — will never be recovered in our timeline. Prise it from the frozen chart room before...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Work out where the log is stowed

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Cross the pack ice to the abandoned ship

Grit 2

FIND

3

Prise the log from the frozen chart room

Craft 3

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Engineer

Find (step 2): Sell → 4¢ · Publish → 1 rep

MODERN

Down House, 1859

Darwin's Suppressed Pages

Days before *On the Origin of Species* goes to the printer, Darwin burns a sheaf of pages he judges too dangerous to publish. There is nothing to take but the words — transcribe them before they go in the grate.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Learn which pages Darwin means to burn

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

+1¢ spoil

2

Reach the study unseen

Grit 1

FIND

3

Transcribe the suppressed pages before the grate

Insight 2

OBJECTIVE

Historian

Find (step 2): Sell → 4¢ · Publish → 1 rep

RECENT · THE PAPER

Amelia's Last Signal

Nikumaroro, 1937

Record only

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

3

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

RECENT · THE PAPER

The Eddington Plates

Príncipe, 1919

Record only

Mystery tier 2 · Debated

REPUTATION

2

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

RECENT · THE PAPER

The Lost Reel

Culver City, 1927

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 2 · Debated

REPUTATION

2

published

SELL

3¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

MODERN · THE PAPER

The Great Stink

London, 1858

Record or Plunder

Mystery tier 2 · Debated

REPUTATION

3

published

SELL

5¢

+1 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

-1

integrity

Record (clean, → Data) or Plunder (→ Artefacts, scars the timeline). Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash + disrepute.

RECENT · THE PAPER

The Roswell Fragment

Lincoln County, 1947

Record or Plunder

Mystery tier 4 · Unknown

REPUTATION

4

published

SELL

6¢

+1 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

-1

integrity

Record (clean, → Data) or Plunder (→ Artefacts, scars the timeline). Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash + disrepute.

RECENT · THE PAPER

The Amber Room Panels

Königsberg, 1945

Record or Plunder

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

3

published

SELL

5¢

+1 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

-1

integrity

Record (clean, → Data) or Plunder (→ Artefacts, scars the timeline). Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash + disrepute.

MODERN · THE PAPER

Darwin's Suppressed Pages

Down House, 1859

Record only

Mystery tier 2 · Debated

REPUTATION

3

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

MODERN · THE PAPER

The Franklin Log

King William Island, 1848

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

4

published

SELL

6¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

MODERN · THE PAPER

Babbage's Lost Cards

London, 1871

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

4

published

SELL

6¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

MODERN

Colorado Springs, 1899

The Tesla Notebook

Inside the experiment station the magnifying transmitter throws bolts across the room while Tesla fills a notebook with resonance figures he will never publish — wireless power, complete. Record the...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Read Tesla's working notes

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Cross the bolt-strewn laboratory floor

Grit 2

FIND

3

Grasp the resonance principle — or take the book

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

Physicist

Find (step 2): Sell → 4¢ · Publish → 2 rep

EARLY MODERN

Birmingham, 1791

Priestley's Lost Apparatus

Days before the Birmingham rioters burn his laboratory, Priestley seals an experimental apparatus in the cellar. Reaching it means slipping past a gathering mob — and the building won't survive the night.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Locate the cellar from the half-burned records

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Divert the gathering rioters from the east door

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Work the cellar lock before the smoke thickens

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

4

Lift the sealed apparatus clear as the timbers catch

Craft 3

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Engineer

Find (step 3): Sell → 5¢ · Publish → 2 rep

EARLY MODERN

Lisbon, 1755

The Engineer's Warning

Moments before the great earthquake, an engineer's seismic notes still lie on his desk. Grab them and get out as the ground opens and the city comes down around you.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the engineer's desk in the failing light

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Brace the buckling doorway

Craft 2

GATE

Engineer

3

Cross the heaving floor

Grit 2

FIND

4

Escape with the seismic notes as the city falls

Grit 3

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Find (step 3): Sell → 5¢ · Publish → 2 rep

EARLY MODERN

Cremona, 1715

The Stradivari Varnish

In the master's workshop the ground coat goes on a half-finished violin — the varnish whose recipe dies with him and has never been reproduced. Win his trust, watch closely, and record what your ears already know...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Win the master's trust

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

+1¢ spoil

2

Keep your place in the busy workshop

Grit 1

DANGER

3

Watch the ground coat go on, brush by brush

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

4

Record the varnish recipe by eye and ear

Insight 2

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 3): Sell → 5¢ · Publish → 2 rep

EARLY MODERN

Cambridge, 1693

Newton's Burned Papers

A candle, an overturned lamp, and a decade of alchemical notebooks gone in an evening — legend blames his dog, Diamond. Reach the chamber on the right night and rescue the notebook history says we lost.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Learn which night the lamp overturns

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Reach the chamber as the fire starts

Grit 2

DANGER

+1¢ spoil

3

Find the alchemical notebook among the flames

Insight 2

FIND

Historian

4

Pull the notebook clear of the blaze

Craft 3

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Engineer

Find (step 3): Sell → 5¢ · Publish → 2 rep

EARLY MODERN

Paris, 1795

The Dauphin's Heart

In the Temple prison a doctor quietly preserves the heart of a dead ten-year-old said to be the lost king Louis XVII. Two centuries of rumour hang on whether it is really his. Take it — and you hold the answer to a...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Confirm the boy's identity from the prison record

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Slip the Temple prison's guard

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Locate the doctor's quiet keeping-place

Insight 1

FIND

4

Take the preserved heart — proof of a king

Insight 2

OBJECTIVE

Physicist

Find (step 3): Sell → 5¢ · Publish → 2 rep

MEDIEVAL

Nuremberg, 1471

The Astronomer's Margins

Regiomontanus kept a second set of notes he never published — calculations decades ahead of their time. A footprint in the wrong cathedral courtyard here would be unlike anything the night watch has ever seen.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the hidden second set of notes

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Cross the cathedral works unseen

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Read the marginal cipher

Insight 2

FIND

Historian

4

Copy the calculations centuries early

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 3): Sell → 6¢ · Publish → 2 rep

MEDIEVAL

Northern Italy, c.1420

The Voynich Quire

In a candlelit scriptorium a scribe is binding the manuscript no one will ever read — an entire quire of which is missing from the copy that survives to our day. Take those lost pages and the world's most stubborn...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the missing quire in the binding

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Slip into the candlelit scriptorium

Grit 1

DANGER

3

Ease the unbound pages free

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

4

Take the pages that unlock the cipher

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 3): Sell → 6¢ · Publish → 3 rep

MEDIEVAL

Constantinople, 717

Greek Fire

As the Arab fleet burns in the Golden Horn, the imperial siphonists guard a secret so well kept it died with the empire and has never been reconstructed. Watch the apparatus work and record the formula no chemist...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Read the siphonists' closely guarded order-book

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

+2¢ spoil

2

Keep your footing on the burning sea wall

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Watch the siphon fire and judge the secret mixture

Insight 3

FIND

Physicist

4

Reconstruct the lost formula step by step

Insight 4

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 3): Sell → 6¢ · Publish → 2 rep

EARLY MODERN · THE PAPER

The Engineer's Warning

Lisbon, 1755

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

5

published

SELL

8¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

EARLY MODERN · THE PAPER

Priestley's Lost Apparatus

Birmingham, 1791

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

5

published

SELL

8¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

MODERN · THE PAPER

The Tesla Notebook

Colorado Springs, 1899

Record or Plunder

Mystery tier 4 · Unknown

REPUTATION

5

published

SELL

8¢

+2 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

-1

integrity

Record (clean, → Data) or Plunder (→ Artefacts, scars the timeline). Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash + disrepute.

EARLY MODERN · THE PAPER

The Dauphin's Heart

Paris, 1795

Record or Plunder

Mystery tier 4 · Unknown

REPUTATION

6

published

SELL

9¢

+2 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

-1

integrity

Record (clean, → Data) or Plunder (→ Artefacts, scars the timeline). Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash + disrepute.

EARLY MODERN · THE PAPER

Newton's Burned Papers

Cambridge, 1693

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

5

published

SELL

8¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

EARLY MODERN · THE PAPER

The Stradivari Varnish

Cremona, 1715

Record only

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

5

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

MEDIEVAL · THE PAPER

Greek Fire

Constantinople, 717

Record only

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

7

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

MEDIEVAL · THE PAPER

The Voynich Quire

Northern Italy, c.1420

Record or Plunder

Mystery tier 4 · Unknown

REPUTATION

8

published

SELL

12¢

+3 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

-2

integrity

Record (clean, → Data) or Plunder (→ Artefacts, scars the timeline). Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash + disrepute.

MEDIEVAL · THE PAPER

The Astronomer's Margins

Nuremberg, 1471

Record only

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

7

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

MEDIEVAL

Damascus, 1200

The Damascus Crucible

A swordsmith draws a blade with a watered pattern no modern forge can reproduce — wootz steel, its process lost for centuries. Earn a place at the forge and record the cycle that made the finest steel of the age.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Earn a place at the forge

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Work the heat of the smithy

Grit 2

DANGER

+1¢ spoil

3

Time the quench and the folding

Craft 3

FIND

Engineer

4

Record the cycle that made wootz steel

Craft 3

OBJECTIVE

Engineer

Find (step 3): Sell → 6¢ · Publish → 2 rep

MEDIEVAL

Montségur, 1244

The Cathar Casket

On the last night before the fortress falls and the perfecti walk into the fire, four men are said to slip down the cliff carrying the Cathars' treasure into legend. Be on the rope beside them and carry out what history only ever...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Learn the perfecti's escape route

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Descend the fortress cliff in the dark

Grit 3

DANGER

3

Hold the rope under the treasure's weight

Grit 2

FIND

4

Carry the Cathar treasure out before the fall

Craft 3

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Engineer

Find (step 3): Sell → 6¢ · Publish → 2 rep

ANCIENT

Alexandria, 48 BC

Before the Fire

A scroll catalogued exactly once, the week before the great library burns. This is deep time — the record is gone, so you cannot know everything you'll meet down there. Why copy what's about to be ash? Seize it.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Talk your way past the librarians

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Slip a scholar's suspicious question

Grit 1

DANGER

3

Navigate the unlit lower stacks

Insight 2

GATE

4

Gather loose ostraca as cover

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

5

Seize the doomed scroll as the shelves begin to burn

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Find (step 4): Sell → 7¢ · Publish → 3 rep

ANCIENT

Aegean Sea, 76 BC

The Antikythera Mechanism

In a Rhodian workshop the bronze gears turn and the model of the heavens runs — a computer two thousand years early. It survives to our age only because the ship sinks; take it now and you erase it. So watch it run, an...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the mechanism in the Rhodian workshop

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Keep your place as it is demonstrated

Grit 1

DANGER

3

Follow the gear-trains as they turn

Insight 3

GATE

Physicist

4

Trace every tooth and ratio

Craft 3

FIND

Engineer

5

Record the whole mechanism before the ship sinks

Insight 4

OBJECTIVE

Physicist

Find (step 4): Sell → 7¢ · Publish → 3 rep

ANCIENT

Pozzuoli, 50 AD

The Roman Mix

The harbour moles have stood in the sea for a century and grown stronger — concrete that heals itself, a recipe argued over and only recently half-recovered. Stand on the works while they pour and record the proportions.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Earn a place on the harbour works

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Work the sea-wall in the surf

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Watch the moles being poured

Craft 2

GATE

Engineer

+2¢ spoil

4

Note the proportions as they mix

Insight 2

FIND

5

Record the self-healing recipe

Craft 3

OBJECTIVE

Engineer

Find (step 4): Sell → 7¢ · Publish → 2 rep

ANCIENT

Cyrene, 50 BC

The Last Silphium

The plant that built a kingdom's fortune — and the only effective contraceptive of the ancient world — is being harvested toward an extinction it will not survive. No botanist has ever seen it grow. Lift one living specimen...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the last wild stand

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Cross the harvested hills

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Identify a viable plant

Insight 2

GATE

4

Dig it out root and all

Grit 3

FIND

5

Lift a living silphium clear before extinction

Craft 3

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Engineer

Find (step 4): Sell → 7¢ · Publish → 3 rep

ANCIENT

Qumran, 60 AD

The Unread Scroll

In the caves above the Dead Sea a community seals its library in jars against the coming legions. One scroll holds a text that never reaches our scholars. Take it, and a gap opens in a record the whole world will one day...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the right cave above the sea

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Reach it before the legions

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Read the jars' markings

Insight 2

GATE

+2¢ spoil

4

Open the sealed jar

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

5

Take the scroll our scholars never read

Insight 4

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 4): Sell → 7¢ · Publish → 3 rep

PREHISTORIC

Anatolia, 9500 BC

The Stone Rings

Hunter-gatherers with no farms, no writing and no metal have raised carved megaliths in rings on a hilltop — a temple built before agriculture, which no one can explain. This is the deepest blind there is. Record why...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Make sense of a people who left no written word

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Endure the exposed hilltop dig

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Read the stones' astronomical alignment

Insight 3

GATE

Physicist

4

Survey how the megaliths were raised without metal

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

5

Record why they built it

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 4): Sell → 8¢ · Publish → 3 rep

PREHISTORIC

Doggerland, 6200 BC

The Drowned Hearth

A people live on the green plain that is now the bed of the North Sea — and a tsunami is hours away from drowning their world forever. Lift their tools from the hearth before the wave erases a country no map...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Read the drowned land's old shoreline

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Reach the plain before the wave

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Find the hearth among the reeds

Insight 2

GATE

4

Dig the tools from the hearth

Grit 2

FIND

5

Lift the tools clear as the sea pours in

Craft 4

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Engineer

Find (step 4): Sell → 8¢ · Publish → 3 rep

ANCIENT · THE PAPER

Before the Fire

Alexandria, 48 BC

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

8

published

SELL

12¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

MEDIEVAL · THE PAPER

The Cathar Casket

Montségur, 1244

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

7

published

SELL

11¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

MEDIEVAL · THE PAPER

The Damascus Crucible

Damascus, 1200

Record only

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

7

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

ANCIENT · THE PAPER

The Last Silphium

Cyrene, 50 BC

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 4 · Unknown

REPUTATION

9

published

SELL

14¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

ANCIENT · THE PAPER

The Roman Mix

Pozzuoli, 50 AD

Record only

Mystery tier 2 · Debated

REPUTATION

7

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

ANCIENT · THE PAPER

The Antikythera Mechanism

Aegean Sea, 76 BC

Record only

Mystery tier 4 · Unknown

REPUTATION

9

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

PREHISTORIC · THE PAPER

The Drowned Hearth

Doggerland, 6200 BC

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 4 · Unknown

REPUTATION

10

published

SELL

15¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

PREHISTORIC · THE PAPER

The Stone Rings

Anatolia, 9500 BC

Record only

Mystery tier 4 · Unknown

REPUTATION

10

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

ANCIENT · THE PAPER

The Unread Scroll

Qumran, 60 AD

Record or Plunder

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

8

published

SELL

12¢

+3 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

-2

integrity

Record (clean, → Data) or Plunder (→ Artefacts, scars the timeline). Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash + disrepute.

PREHISTORIC

Wrangel Island, 2000 BC

The Last Mammoth

On a cold island the very last mammoths on Earth still walk, long after the mainland forgot them. You could sedate one, take tissue and a tusk — or bring a living calf back through the door. Pulling a creature out of its ow...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Track the last herd on the island

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Cross the frozen island

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Judge the herd for a healthy calf

Insight 3

GATE

Physicist

4

Sedate one and take tissue and tusk

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

5

Bring a living calf back through the door

Grit 3

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 4): Sell → 8¢ · Publish → 3 rep

PREHISTORIC

Akrotiri, 1600 BC

Before Thera

A Bronze-Age town of running water and painted walls sits in the shadow of a volcano that is about to bury it whole. The ground is already shaking. Take the bronze hoard from the merchant's house and run for the boats.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the merchant's house in the town

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Cross the shaking streets

Grit 3

DANGER

3

Identify the bronze hoard

Insight 2

GATE

+2¢ spoil

4

Break open the merchant's store

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

5

Take the hoard and run for the boats

Grit 4

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Find (step 4): Sell → 8¢ · Publish → 3 rep

PREHISTORIC

Ardèche, 30000 BC

The Painters of Chauvet

Deep in a cave lit by tallow lamps, Ice-Age artists draw lions and horses with a sophistication that will not be matched for thirty thousand years. There is nothing to carry out — only the impossible chance to record the...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the painted chamber deep in the cave

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Crawl the tallow-lit passages

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Watch the artists at work

Insight 2

GATE

4

Read the lamplight and the pigments

Insight 2

FIND

Physicist

5

Record the oldest masters before the lamps gutter

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 4): Sell → 8¢ · Publish → 3 rep

RECENT

Delaware, Ohio, 1977

The Wow! Signal

For 72 seconds a radio telescope catches a narrowband signal so strong the astronomer scrawls 'Wow!' in the margin. It never repeats, and no one has ever explained it. Be in the control room and record the source before ...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Predict the window from the telescope's drift

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Hold the control room's nerve

Grit 1

FIND

3

Log the signal's source before it falls silent

Insight 2

OBJECTIVE

Physicist

Find (step 2): Sell → 3¢ · Publish → 1 rep

RECENT

Lakehurst, 1937

The Doped Skin

Why the Hindenburg burned so fast is still argued — the hydrogen, or the aluminium-laced fabric of its skin. Cut a sample from the airship on the apron, minutes before the spark, and the question is answerable at last.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Mark the doped panel from the crew's notes

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Work the mooring apron unnoticed

Grit 1

FIND

3

Cut a skin sample minutes before the spark

Craft 2

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Engineer

Find (step 2): Sell → 3¢ · Publish → 1 rep

RECENT

Podkamennaya Tunguska, 1908

The Tunguska Core

Something flattens two thousand square kilometres of Siberian forest and leaves no crater — comet, asteroid, or stranger. Reach the blast site in the days after and a fragment of whatever fell would settle a century of...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Plot the blast's centre from the felled trees

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Cross the shattered taiga

Grit 1

FIND

3

Recover a fragment of whatever fell

Insight 2

OBJECTIVE

Physicist

Find (step 2): Sell → 3¢ · Publish → 1 rep

RECENT

Ural Mountains, 1959

Dyatlov Pass

Nine experienced hikers cut their way out of their tent into a -30° night and die scattered across the slope, some with injuries no one can explain. There is nothing to carry home — only the chance to watch what really...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Reconstruct the hikers' route

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Endure the -30° night on the slope

Grit 1

FIND

3

Record what drives them from the tent

Insight 1

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 2): Sell → 3¢ · Publish → 1 rep

RECENT

Qinhuangdao, 1941

The Peking Man Crates

The Peking Man fossils — humanity's own deep past — are crated for evacuation as the war closes in, and somewhere on the road to the coast they vanish from history for good. Intercept the crates before they're los...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Trace the crates to the rail yard

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

+1¢ spoil

2

Reach the convoy as the war closes in

Grit 1

FIND

3

Intercept the crates before they vanish

Craft 2

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Engineer

Find (step 2): Sell → 3¢ · Publish → 1 rep

MODERN

Azores, 1872

The Mary Celeste

A merchant brig is found mid-Atlantic in perfect order — sails set, cargo intact, and not a soul aboard, the lifeboat gone and no explanation ever found. Step onto the deck in the hours before the crew abandon it and record why.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Reconstruct the brig's last hours

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Board the silent ship mid-Atlantic

Grit 1

FIND

3

Witness and record why they abandon her

Insight 2

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 2): Sell → 4¢ · Publish → 2 rep

PREHISTORIC · THE PAPER

The Painters of Chauvet

Ardèche, 30000 BC

Record only

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

9

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

PREHISTORIC · THE PAPER

Before Thera

Akrotiri, 1600 BC

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

9

published

SELL

14¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

PREHISTORIC · THE PAPER

The Last Mammoth

Wrangel Island, 2000 BC

Record or Plunder

Mystery tier 4 · Unknown

REPUTATION

10

published

SELL

15¢

+4 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

-3

integrity

Record (clean, → Data) or Plunder (→ Artefacts, scars the timeline). Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash + disrepute.

RECENT · THE PAPER

The Tunguska Core

Podkamennaya Tunguska, 1908

Record or Plunder

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

3

published

SELL

5¢

+1 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

-1

integrity

Record (clean, → Data) or Plunder (→ Artefacts, scars the timeline). Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash + disrepute.

RECENT · THE PAPER

The Doped Skin

Lakehurst, 1937

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 2 · Debated

REPUTATION

2

published

SELL

3¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

RECENT · THE PAPER

The Wow! Signal

Delaware, Ohio, 1977

Record only

Mystery tier 4 · Unknown

REPUTATION

4

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

MODERN · THE PAPER

The Mary Celeste

Azores, 1872

Record only

Mystery tier 4 · Unknown

REPUTATION

5

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

RECENT · THE PAPER

The Peking Man Crates

Qinhuangdao, 1941

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

3

published

SELL

5¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

RECENT · THE PAPER

Dyatlov Pass

Ural Mountains, 1959

Record only

Mystery tier 4 · Unknown

REPUTATION

4

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

MODERN

Lyme Regis, 1823

Anning's Ichthyosaur

On the crumbling Dorset cliffs the greatest fossil-hunter of the age prides a sea-dragon from the rock — and gets none of the credit her gentleman buyers will claim. Copy her method and her find, or lift the specimen yourself.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Follow Anning's eye along the cliff

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

+1c

spoil

2

Work the crumbling Dorset cliff face

Grit 2

FIND

3

Free the sea-dragon from the rock

Craft 2

OBJECTIVE

Engineer

Find (step 2): Sell → 4c · Publish → 1 rep

MODERN

Vienna, 1847

Semmelweis's Ledger

A young doctor halves the deaths on his ward simply by making everyone wash their hands — and the medical establishment ruins him for the insult of it. Copy the mortality ledger that proves he was right, decades too...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the ward's mortality records

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Move through the hostile hospital

Grit 1

FIND

3

Copy the ledger that proves him right

Insight 1

OBJECTIVE

Historian

Find (step 2): Sell → 4c · Publish → 1 rep

MODERN

Lake Bangweulu, 1873

Livingstone's Last Journals

Dying in a swamp far beyond any map, the explorer fills the last of his field journals — pages his companions will carry a thousand miles, and some that will never arrive. Reach the camp and save the ones history loses.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Locate the explorer's field journals

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Wade into the fever-swamp camp

Grit 2

FIND

3

Save the journals history loses

Craft 2

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Engineer

Find (step 2): Sell → 4c · Publish → 1 rep

MODERN

Dundee, 1879

The Tay Bridge Notes

On a storm night the longest bridge in the world buckles and drops a train and seventy-five souls into the firth. The engineer's calculations — and the flaw hidden in them — go down with the central spans. Take the notes...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the flaw in the engineer's calculations

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Reach the bridge office as the gale rises

Grit 1

FIND

3

Take the notes before the spans drop

Craft 3

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Engineer

Find (step 2): Sell → 4c · Publish → 1 rep

EARLY MODERN

Roanoke Island, 1590

The Lost Colony

The relief ship returns to find the colony gone — the houses dismantled, no graves, no struggle, only the word CROATOAN carved into a post. Walk the empty stockade in the weeks before they vanish and record...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Read the colony's last messages

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Walk the emptying stockade

Grit 1

DANGER

3

Search the dismantled houses for a sign

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

4

Record where a hundred souls went

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

Historian

Find (step 3): Sell → 5c · Publish → 2 rep

EARLY MODERN

The Solent, 1545

The Mary Rose

Henry's great warship heels in a turn, takes water through her open gunports, and goes down in minutes within sight of the king. Get below as she rolls and haul the master's instruments clear before the Solent closes...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find where the master's instruments are kept

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

+1c

spoil

2

Get below as she heels over

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Work the cabinet open against the list

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

4

Haul the instruments clear before the Solent closes

Grit 3

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Find (step 3): Sell → 5c · Publish → 1 rep

EARLY MODERN

Vienna, 1770

The Mechanical Turk

A clockwork automaton in a turban beats noblemen at chess and tours the courts of Europe as a wonder — and the secret of how it really works dies with its maker. Get inside the cabinet between matches and record the tric...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Learn the automaton's touring schedule

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Get into the cabinet between matches

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Trace the clockwork linkages

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

4

Record how the trick really works

Insight 2

OBJECTIVE

Physicist

Find (step 3): Sell → 5c · Publish → 2 rep

EARLY MODERN

Vienna, 1741

Vivaldi's Lost Operas

The most famous composer in Europe dies forgotten and penniless in a rented room, and the bound scores of operas no one will ever hear again are about to be sold off as waste paper. Reach the lodgings first and carry...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the rented lodgings before the sale

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Reach the rooms ahead of the dealers

Grit 1

DANGER

3

Sort the opera scores from the waste

Insight 1

FIND

Historian

4

Carry the bound scores out

Craft 2

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Engineer

Find (step 3): Sell → 5c · Publish → 2 rep

EARLY MODERN

Prague, 1601

The Astronomer's Death

Tycho Brahe dies eleven days after a banquet, in agony, and the centuries will argue whether it was a burst bladder, mercury, or murder by a rival who wanted his data. A sample from the deathbed would end the debat...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Reconstruct the astronomer's last days

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Reach the deathbed unchallenged

Grit 1

DANGER

3

Judge the symptoms at the bedside

Insight 2

FIND

4

Take a sample to end the murder debate

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

Physicist

Find (step 3): Sell → 5c · Publish → 2 rep

MODERN · THE PAPER

Livingstone's Last Journals

Lake Bangweulu, 1873

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

4

published

SELL

6¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

MODERN · THE PAPER

Semmelweis's Ledger

Vienna, 1847

Record only

Mystery tier 2 · Debated

REPUTATION

3

published

PLUNDER SCAR

−0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

MODERN · THE PAPER

Anning's Ichthyosaur

Lyme Regis, 1823

Record or Plunder

Mystery tier 2 · Debated

REPUTATION

3

published

SELL

5¢

+1 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

−1

integrity

Record (clean, → Data) or Plunder (→ Artefacts, scars the timeline). Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash + disrepute.

EARLY MODERN · THE PAPER

The Mary Rose

The Solent, 1545

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 2 · Debated

REPUTATION

4

published

SELL

6¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

EARLY MODERN · THE PAPER

The Lost Colony

Roanoke Island, 1590

Record only

Mystery tier 4 · Unknown

REPUTATION

6

published

PLUNDER SCAR

−0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

MODERN · THE PAPER

The Tay Bridge Notes

Dundee, 1879

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

4

published

SELL

6¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

EARLY MODERN · THE PAPER

The Astronomer's Death

Prague, 1601

Record or Plunder

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

5

published

SELL

8¢

+2 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

−1

integrity

Record (clean, → Data) or Plunder (→ Artefacts, scars the timeline). Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash + disrepute.

EARLY MODERN · THE PAPER

Vivaldi's Lost Operas

Vienna, 1741

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

5

published

SELL

8¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

EARLY MODERN · THE PAPER

The Mechanical Turk

Vienna, 1770

Record only

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

5

published

PLUNDER SCAR

−0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

MEDIEVAL

Tower of London, 1483

The Princes in the Tower

Two boy-kings are lodged in the Tower 'for their safety' and are never seen alive again — and England will argue for five hundred years over who killed them, and whether anyone did. Walk the royal apartments in the...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Map the royal apartments

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Move through the Tower unseen

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Work past the locked apartments

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

4

Record what becomes of the princes

Insight 4

OBJECTIVE

Historian

Find (step 3): Sell → 6¢ · Publish → 3 rep

MEDIEVAL

Malmesbury, 1010

The Flying Monk

A monk straps wings to his arms and feet, leaps from the abbey tower, and glides the length of a furlong before he falls and breaks his legs — five centuries before anyone else dares try. Watch the launch and you can copy the...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Study the monk's wing design

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Climb to the abbey tower

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Examine the strapped wings

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

4

Copy the contraption — or carry it home

Craft 3

OBJECTIVE

Engineer

Find (step 3): Sell → 6¢ · Publish → 2 rep

MEDIEVAL

La Rochelle, 1307

The Templar Fleet

On the night before Friday the thirteenth, when the king's men come for every Templar in France, eighteen ships slip out of the harbour loaded with the order's treasure and sail into legend, never seen again. Be on...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Learn which ships sail that night

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

+2¢ spoil

2

Reach the harbour before the king's men

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Break the strongboxes from the vault

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

4

Run the treasure aboard before dawn

Grit 3

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Find (step 3): Sell → 6¢ · Publish → 2 rep

ANCIENT

Syracuse, 212 BC

The Sack of Syracuse

The Romans are pouring over the walls and a soldier is minutes from running the old geometer through mid-proof, his workshop of impossible machines about to be looted and lost. Reach the house first and carry...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find Archimedes' house in the falling city

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

+2¢ spoil

2

Reach it ahead of the legionaries

Grit 3

DANGER

3

Make sense of the impossible machines

Insight 3

GATE

4

Pack the apparatus to move

Craft 3

FIND

Engineer

5

Carry the machines out of the burning city

Craft 4

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Engineer

Find (step 4): Sell → 7¢ · Publish → 3 rep

ANCIENT

Roman Gaul, 200 AD

The Bronze Dodecahedron

A hollow bronze twelve-sided object, knobbed at every corner and bored with holes of carefully different sizes, sits on a craftsman's bench — and no one in eighteen centuries will agree what it is for. Watch him use it, or...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the craftsman's bench

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Wait out the busy workshop

Grit 1

DANGER

3

Watch how he uses the thing

Insight 3

GATE

4

Measure its holes and knobs

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

5

Take the dodecahedron — or record its use

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

Physicist

Find (step 4): Sell → 7¢ · Publish → 3 rep

PREHISTORIC

Salisbury Plain, 2500 BC

The Raising of the Stones

A people with no metal, no wheel and no writing are hauling bluestones a hundred and fifty miles and standing them in a ring aligned to the turning sky — and how, and why, is a question that outlives every theory...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Make sense of a people with no writing

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Stand among the hauling crews

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Study how the sarsens are dressed

Craft 3

GATE

Engineer

4

Read the ring's alignment to the sky

Insight 2

FIND

Physicist

5

Record how and why they raise the stones

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

Historian

Find (step 4): Sell → 8¢ · Publish → 3 rep

MANY WORLDS

The Multiverse

The First Door

Not a place in history but a place beside it — the branch point where every timeline that could have been still runs. Crossing needs every mind and every machine the table can muster. Open the door and humanity reaches...

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Hold the branch point steady in the mathematics

Insight 3

GATE

Physicist

2

Tune every machine at the table in unison

Craft 3

GATE

Engineer

3

Withstand the crossing's tearing forces

Grit 4

DANGER

4

Read the door's shifting geometry

Insight 4

GATE

Physicist

5

Hold the door open long enough to cross

Craft 5

OBJECTIVE

Engineer

The door is the only prize.

MANY WORLDS

The Multiverse

The Converging Paths

Every path you and your rivals ever walked converges on a single threshold of light. It will not hold open long, and it will not open at all for anyone who comes alone. Step through together — or fray the timeline trying.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Hold the threshold's tearing light

Grit 3

DANGER

2

Read the converging paths

Insight 3

GATE

Physicist

3

Lock every machine to the same instant

Craft 4

GATE

Engineer

4

Withstand the crossing together

Grit 4

DANGER

5

Step through before the threshold closes

Insight 5

OBJECTIVE

Physicist

The door is the only prize.

RECENT

Adelaide, 1948

The Somerton Man

A dead man on a beach, no name, and a scrap in his job pocket reading "Tamám Shud." Copy the torn page and the code pencilled beneath it before the case goes cold forever.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Match the man to a missing name

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Search the body before the case is filed

Grit 1

FIND

3

Copy the torn page and its pencilled code

Insight 1

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 2): Sell → 3¢ · Publish → 1 rep

Complete all five steps to open the multiverse and end the game in Triumph. Any failed step frays the timeline.

RECENT

Outer Hebrides, 1900

The Flannan Light

Three keepers gone from a sealed lighthouse, the table set, one chair toppled. Reach the last log entry before the next storm takes the logbook with it.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Read the keepers' last entries

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Climb to the sealed light room

Grit 1

FIND

3

Save the logbook before the storm

Craft 1

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Engineer

Find (step 2): Sell → 3¢ · Publish → 1 rep

RECENT

off Barbados, 1918

The Cyclops

A Navy collier and three hundred men vanished without a wreck or a distress call. Get aboard and grab the manifest in the hours before she goes down.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Force the jammed hold doors

Craft 1

GATE

Engineer

2

Keep your feet on the canting deck

Grit 1

FIND

3

Find the manifest before she goes down

Insight 2

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Find (step 2): Sell → 3¢ · Publish → 1 rep

RECENT

English Channel, 1944

Miller's Flight

The bandleader's plane left for Paris and never arrived. Pull the flight log from the cockpit before the Channel swallows it.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Plot the plane's track over the Channel

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Reach the wreck in the cold water

Grit 1

FIND

3

Pull the flight log from the flooded cockpit

Craft 2

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Engineer

Find (step 2): Sell → 3¢ · Publish → 1 rep

RECENT

Ghent, 1934

The Just Judges

A single panel cut from the Ghent Altarpiece, never recovered, its location taunted in a deathbed letter. Photograph it where it hides — or lift it for yourself.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Read the thief's deathbed letter

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Work into the panel's hidden recess

Craft 1

FIND

Engineer

3

Photograph the Just Judges where it hides

Insight 1

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 2): Sell → 3¢ · Publish → 1 rep

RECENT

Mato Grosso, 1925

The Road to Z

Colonel Fawcett walked into the Amazon chasing a lost city and was never seen again. Recover his last notebook from the camp before the jungle erases it.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Endure the deep jungle

Grit 1

DANGER

2

Find the expedition's last camp

Insight 1

FIND

Historian

3

Recover Fawcett's final notebook

Insight 1

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Find (step 2): Sell → 3¢ · Publish → 1 rep

RECENT

Vienna, 1918

The Florentine

A 137-carat yellow diamond vanished as the Habsburg empire fell. Catalogue it as it changes hands — or simply take it into the dark.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Trace the diamond through the fallen court

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Move unseen among the fleeing household

Grit 1

FIND

3

Lift the Florentine into the dark

Craft 1

OBJECTIVE

Engineer

Find (step 2): Sell → 3¢ · Publish → 1 rep

RECENT

Honeysuckle Creek, 1969

The Erased Tapes

The original slow-scan tapes of the first Moon landing, taped over by accident and lost. Copy the master reels before they are wiped clean.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Work out which reels hold the originals

Insight 1

GATE

Physicist

2

Reach the tracking station's vault

Grit 1

FIND

3

Copy the original Moon-landing tapes

Craft 1

OBJECTIVE

Engineer

Find (step 2): Sell → 3¢ · Publish → 1 rep

MODERN

Devon, 1855

The Devil's Footprints

A hundred miles of cloven hoofprints crossing roofs and walled gardens, made in a single frozen night. Record the trail before the thaw takes it.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Map the hundred-mile trail of prints

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Follow the prints across the frozen night

Grit 1

FIND

3

Record the trail before the thaw

Insight 1

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 2): Sell → 4¢ · Publish → 1 rep

MODERN

Chihuahua, 1913

Bierce's Last Dispatch

The writer rode into a revolution and out of all record. Snatch his final dispatch from the saddlebag before the column is ambushed.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Ride with the revolution's column

Grit 1

DANGER

2

Find Bierce among the marching men

Insight 1

FIND

Historian

3

Snatch his final dispatch before the ambush

Insight 1

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Find (step 2): Sell → 4¢ · Publish → 1 rep

RECENT · THE PAPER

Miller's Flight

English Channel, 1944

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 2 · Debated

REPUTATION

2

published

SELL

3¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

RECENT · THE PAPER

The Cyclops

off Barbados, 1918

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 2 · Debated

REPUTATION

2

published

SELL

3¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

RECENT · THE PAPER

The Flannan Light

Outer Hebrides, 1900

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

3

published

SELL

5¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

RECENT · THE PAPER

The Florentine

Vienna, 1918

Record or Plunder

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

3

published

SELL

5¢

+1 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

-1

integrity

Record (clean, → Data) or Plunder (→ Artefacts, scars the timeline). Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash + disrepute.

RECENT · THE PAPER

The Road to Z

Mato Grosso, 1925

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

3

published

SELL

5¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

RECENT · THE PAPER

The Just Judges

Ghent, 1934

Record or Plunder

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

3

published

SELL

5¢

+1 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

-1

integrity

Record (clean, → Data) or Plunder (→ Artefacts, scars the timeline). Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash + disrepute.

MODERN · THE PAPER

Bierce's Last Dispatch

Chihuahua, 1913

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 2 · Debated

REPUTATION

3

published

SELL

5¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

MODERN · THE PAPER

The Devil's Footprints

Devon, 1855

Record only

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

4

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

RECENT · THE PAPER

The Erased Tapes

Honeysuckle Creek, 1969

Record only

Mystery tier 2 · Debated

REPUTATION

2

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

MODERN

off Durban, 1909

The Waratah

The "Titanic of the South" steamed into a swell with 211 aboard and was never found. Get the bridge log before she founders.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Work below as the ship labours

Craft 1

GATE

Engineer

2

Hold on through the mountainous swell

Grit 2

FIND

3

Get the bridge log before she founders

Insight 2

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Historian

Find (step 2): Sell → 4¢ · Publish → 1 rep

MODERN

Nuremberg, 1828

The Foundling

A youth appeared in the square able to write one name and nothing else, then was murdered before anyone learned his. Copy the papers he carried.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Trace the foundling's few known facts

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Reach him before the assassin does

Grit 1

FIND

3

Copy the papers he carried

Insight 1

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 2): Sell → 4¢ · Publish → 1 rep

MODERN

Charleston, 1864

The Hunley

The first submarine to sink a warship then sank itself, crew at their stations, for reasons unknown. Recover the mechanism before it settles in the silt.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Open the sunken hatch

Craft 1

GATE

Engineer

2

Hold your air in the silted dark

Grit 2

FIND

3

Recover the mechanism before it settles

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Physicist

Find (step 2): Sell → 4¢ · Publish → 1 rep

MODERN

Washington, 1865

The Missing Pages

Eighteen pages cut from the assassin's diary, their fate a century of accusation. Photograph them before they are excised.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find where the pages went

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Reach the diary under guard

Grit 1

FIND

3

Photograph the eighteen pages before they are cut

Craft 2

OBJECTIVE

Engineer

Find (step 2): Sell → 4¢ · Publish → 1 rep

MODERN

Georgia, 1865

The Treasury Train

The Confederate treasury left Richmond by rail and never reached its destination. Tally the crates where they were buried — or carry them off.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Track the treasury train's route

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Reach the burial site ahead of the pursuers

Grit 1

FIND

3

Count the crates — or carry them off

Insight 1

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 2): Sell → 4¢ · Publish → 1 rep

MODERN

Sumbawa, 1815

The Year Without Summer

A mountain erupted and stole a summer from the whole world the next year. Measure the ash column before the records of the blast are buried with it.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Calculate the eruption's force

Insight 1

GATE

Physicist

2

Stand off the erupting mountain

Grit 2

FIND

3

Measure the ash column at its height

Insight 2

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 2): Sell → 4¢ · Publish → 1 rep

EARLY MODERN

Panama, 1698

The Darien Venture

Scotland staked its wealth on a colony in the fever-coast jungle, and lost both. Take the company's last ledger before the survivors burn the stockade.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the company's records in the stockade

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Endure the fever-coast jungle

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Break into the locked counting-house

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

4

Take the last ledger before the survivors burn it

Insight 2

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Find (step 3): Sell → 5¢ · Publish → 1 rep

EARLY MODERN

Florence, 1505

The Lost Battle

Leonardo's unfinished mural, perhaps still sealed behind a later wall in the great hall. Record the surface that hides it — or cut it free.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Read Vasari's records for the wall

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Work the great hall after hours

Grit 1

DANGER

3

Sound the wall for the hidden surface

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

4

Record the mural — or cut it free

Craft 3

OBJECTIVE

Engineer

Find (step 3): Sell → 5¢ · Publish → 2 rep

EARLY MODERN

London, 1613

Cardenio

A play by Shakespeare, performed at court and then gone from every shelf. Copy the prompt-book before the playhouse fire claims it.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find which company holds the play

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Slip backstage at the playhouse

Grit 1

DANGER

3

Locate the prompt-book

Insight 1

FIND

4

Copy the prompt-book before the fire

Insight 2

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 3): Sell → 5¢ · Publish → 2 rep

MODERN · THE PAPER

The Hunley

Charleston, 1864

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

4

published

SELL

6¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

MODERN · THE PAPER

The Foundling

Nuremberg, 1828

Record only

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

4

published

PLUNDER SCAR

−0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

MODERN · THE PAPER

The Waratah

off Durban, 1909

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 2 · Debated

REPUTATION

3

published

SELL

5¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

MODERN · THE PAPER

The Year Without Summer

Sumbawa, 1815

Record only

Mystery tier 2 · Debated

REPUTATION

3

published

PLUNDER SCAR

−0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

MODERN · THE PAPER

The Treasury Train

Georgia, 1865

Record or Plunder

Mystery tier 2 · Debated

REPUTATION

3

published

SELL

5¢

+1 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

−1

integrity

Record (clean, → Data) or Plunder (→ Artefacts, scars the timeline). Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash + disrepute.

MODERN · THE PAPER

The Missing Pages

Washington, 1865

Record only

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

4

published

PLUNDER SCAR

−0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

EARLY MODERN · THE PAPER

Cardenio

London, 1613

Record only

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

5

published

PLUNDER SCAR

−0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

EARLY MODERN · THE PAPER

The Lost Battle

Florence, 1505

Record or Plunder

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

5

published

SELL

8¢

+2 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

−1

integrity

Record (clean, → Data) or Plunder (→ Artefacts, scars the timeline). Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash + disrepute.

EARLY MODERN · THE PAPER

The Darien Venture

Panama, 1698

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 2 · Debated

REPUTATION

4

published

SELL

6¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

EARLY MODERN

Edinburgh, 1567

The Casket Letters

The letters that sent a queen to the block — authentic, or forged to fit. Transcribe them, or spirit the casket away whole.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Trace the casket to its keeper

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Reach the locked study

Grit 1

DANGER

3

Read the letters' contested hand

Insight 2

FIND

Historian

4

Transcribe them — or take the casket whole

Insight 2

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 3): Sell → 5¢ · Publish → 2 rep

EARLY MODERN

Strait of Malacca, 1511

Flor de la Mar

A carrack so laden with a sultanate's plunder she could not be saved, lost on the homeward reef. Reach the strongroom before she breaks apart.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the strongroom on the carrack's plan

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Reach the wreck on the reef

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Force the flooded strongroom door

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

4

Take the treasure before she breaks apart

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Find (step 3): Sell → 5¢ · Publish → 2 rep

EARLY MODERN

Bermuda, 1609

The Sea Venture

Wrecked on a reef thought to be devils, her castaways built two new ships and a legend. Salvage the captain's account as the hull works apart.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Work the wreck on the reef

Craft 1

GATE

Engineer

2

Hold on as the hull works apart

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Find the captain's log in the flooding cabin

Insight 1

FIND

Historian

4

Salvage the account before she breaks up

Insight 2

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Find (step 3): Sell → 5¢ · Publish → 1 rep

MEDIEVAL

Baghdad, 1258

The House of Wisdom

The Mongols emptied the great libraries into the Tigris until it ran black with ink. Pull what you can from the shelves before the river takes the rest.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the most precious shelves

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Push through the sacked streets

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Choose what to save in moments

Insight 2

FIND

Historian

4

Pull the manuscripts before the river takes them

Insight 4

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Find (step 3): Sell → 6¢ · Publish → 3 rep

MEDIEVAL

Strasbourg, 1518

The Dancing Plague

Hundreds danced in the streets for days, some until they dropped dead, and no one knows why. Record the affliction before the city erases the shame.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Trace the plague to its first dancer

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Move among the dancing crowd

Grit 1

DANGER

3

Watch the dancers to exhaustion

Insight 2

FIND

4

Record the affliction before it's erased

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 3): Sell → 6¢ · Publish → 2 rep

MEDIEVAL

Newfoundland, c.1000

The Vinland Houses

Norse turf halls on a coast five centuries before Columbus, then abandoned to the fog. Measure the settlement — or carry off its ironwork.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Read the sagas for the landing site

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Cross the fog-bound coast

Grit 1

DANGER

3

Survey the turf halls

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

4

Measure the settlement — or take its ironwork

Insight 2

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 3): Sell → 6¢ · Publish → 2 rep

MEDIEVAL

Hakata Bay, 1281

The Divine Wind

The largest armada the world had seen, scattered and drowned by a typhoon overnight. Reach a flagship's hold before the wind finishes its work.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Work the wreck in the bay

Craft 1

GATE

Engineer

2

Dive the typhoon-scattered fleet

Grit 3

DANGER

3

Find the flagship among the wrecks

Insight 2

FIND

Historian

4

Reach the hold before the wind finishes

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Find (step 3): Sell → 6¢ · Publish → 2 rep

MEDIEVAL

Woolpit, c.1150

The Green Children

Two children, skin tinged green, speaking no known tongue, found at the edge of a harvest field. Record their account before it passes into folktale.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the field where they appeared

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Win the wary children's trust

Grit 1

DANGER

3

Make sense of their unknown tongue

Insight 3

FIND

4

Record their account before it turns to folktale

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 3): Sell → 6¢ · Publish → 2 rep

ANCIENT

Crete, c.1700 BC

The Phaistos Spiral

A clay disc stamped in a spiral with signs no scholar can read, alone of its kind. Copy both faces before the palace burns around it.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the disc in the palace stores

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Move through the palace unseen

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Study the spiral of stamped signs

Insight 3

GATE

Historian

4

Take a careful impression

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

5

Copy both faces before the palace burns

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 4): Sell → 7¢ · Publish → 3 rep

EARLY MODERN · THE PAPER

The Sea Venture

Bermuda, 1609

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 2 · Debated

REPUTATION

4

published

SELL

6¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

EARLY MODERN · THE PAPER

Flor de la Mar

Strait of Malacca, 1511

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

5

published

SELL

8¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

EARLY MODERN · THE PAPER

The Casket Letters

Edinburgh, 1567

Record or Plunder

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

5

published

SELL

8¢

+2 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

-1

integrity

Record (clean, → Data) or Plunder (→ Artefacts, scars the timeline). Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash + disrepute.

MEDIEVAL · THE PAPER

The Vinland Houses

Newfoundland, c.1000

Record or Plunder

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

7

published

SELL

11¢

+3 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

-2

integrity

Record (clean, → Data) or Plunder (→ Artefacts, scars the timeline). Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash + disrepute.

MEDIEVAL · THE PAPER

The Dancing Plague

Strasbourg, 1518

Record only

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

7

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

MEDIEVAL · THE PAPER

The House of Wisdom

Baghdad, 1258

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 4 · Unknown

REPUTATION

8

published

SELL

12¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

ANCIENT · THE PAPER

The Phaistos Spiral

Crete, c.1700 BC

Record only

Mystery tier 4 · Unknown

REPUTATION

9

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

MEDIEVAL · THE PAPER

The Green Children

Woolpit, c.1150

Record only

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

7

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

MEDIEVAL · THE PAPER

The Divine Wind

Hakata Bay, 1281

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

7

published

SELL

11¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

ANCIENT

Ugarit, c.1177 BC

The Sea Peoples

Raiders no one could name brought a dozen kingdoms down in a single generation. Read the last tablets baked in the burning city before it falls.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the archive in the burning city

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Reach it as the raiders close in

Grit 3

DANGER

3

Sort the diplomatic tablets

Insight 2

GATE

4

Save the tablets from the flames

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

5

Read who brought the kingdoms down

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 4): Sell → 7¢ · Publish → 3 rep

ANCIENT

Xi'an, 210 BC

The Mercury Sea

The first emperor's tomb, sealed over rivers of mercury and a buried army. Map the chamber — or breach it and take what the crossbows guard.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Read the court records for the tomb's plan

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Cross the mercury moat's poisoned vapours

Grit 3

DANGER

3

Disarm the buried crossbow triggers

Craft 2

GATE

Engineer

4

Map the mercury rivers and their strange currents

Insight 2

FIND

Physicist

5

Breach the sealed inner chamber

Insight 4

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 4): Sell → 7¢ · Publish → 3 rep

ANCIENT

Eboracum, c.120 AD

The Ninth

Five thousand legionaries marched north into the mist and vanished from every roll. Recover the fort's last muster before the record is struck out.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the fort's record room

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

March north into the mist

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Trace the legion's last orders

Insight 2

GATE

4

Break into the strong-room

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

5

Recover the last muster before it's struck out

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 4): Sell → 7¢ · Publish → 3 rep

ANCIENT

Nazca, c.500 AD

The Sky Drawings

Lines miles long, shaped into creatures only the sky can see in full. Survey them before the desert wind blurs their edges for good.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find your bearings on the empty pampa

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Walk the lines under the desert sun

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Trace a single figure end to end

Insight 2

GATE

4

Map the figures from the heights

Insight 3

FIND

5

Survey them before the wind blurs the edges

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 4): Sell → 7¢ · Publish → 3 rep

PREHISTORIC

Altai, c.50,000 BP

The Denisovan

A whole kind of human known from a single fingerbone in a cave. Recover a living trace before the layer is lost to the dig.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Place the cave's deep layers in order

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Work the unstable dig

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Identify the Denisovan layer

Insight 3

GATE

Physicist

4

Extract the fingerbone intact

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

5

Recover a living trace before the layer is lost

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Find (step 4): Sell → 8¢ · Publish → 3 rep

PREHISTORIC

Blombos, c.73,000 BP

The First Mark

A cross-hatch scratched in ochre — the oldest drawing a human hand ever made. Record it before the ochre crumbles to dust.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Find the ochre piece in the cave fill

Insight 1

GATE

Historian

2

Work the coastal cave

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Make out the cross-hatched marks

Insight 2

GATE

4

Steady the crumbling ochre

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

5

Record the first mark before it turns to dust

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 4): Sell → 8¢ · Publish → 3 rep

PREHISTORIC

Yunnan, c.14,000 BP

The Red Deer People

People with ancient features who should have been gone for ages, yet were not. Take a specimen before the cave roof comes down.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Date the cave's strange remains

Insight 2

GATE

Historian

2

Shore up the failing cave roof

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Read the ancient features in the bones

Insight 3

GATE

4

Judge how a vanished people survived

Insight 2

FIND

Physicist

5

Take a specimen before the roof comes down

Insight 4

OBJECTIVE

DOOMED

Find (step 4): Sell → 8¢ · Publish → 3 rep

PREHISTORIC

Hiawatha, c.12,800 BP

The Long Winter

A sky-fire that may have plunged the warming world back into ice for a thousand years. Measure the impact layer before the meltwater scours it away.

THE EXPEDITION →

1

Locate the buried impact horizon

Insight 2

GATE

Physicist

2

Cross the meltwater channels

Grit 2

DANGER

3

Read the dark layer in the ice

Insight 3

GATE

4

Core the impact layer

Craft 2

FIND

Engineer

5

Measure it before the meltwater scours it

Insight 3

OBJECTIVE

Find (step 4): Sell → 8¢ · Publish → 3 rep

ANCIENT · THE PAPER

The Ninth

Eboracum, c.120 AD

Record only

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

8

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

ANCIENT · THE PAPER

The Mercury Sea

Xi'an, 210 BC

Record or Plunder

Mystery tier 4 · Unknown

REPUTATION

9

published

SELL

14¢

+4 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

-2

integrity

Record (clean, → Data) or Plunder (→ Artefacts, scars the timeline). Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash + disrepute.

ANCIENT · THE PAPER

The Sea Peoples

Ugarit, c.1177 BC

Record only

Mystery tier 4 · Unknown

REPUTATION

9

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

PREHISTORIC · THE PAPER

The First Mark

Blombos, c.73,000 BP

Record only

Mystery tier 4 · Unknown

REPUTATION

10

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

PREHISTORIC · THE PAPER

The Denisovan

Altai, c.50,000 BP

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 4 · Unknown

REPUTATION

10

published

SELL

15¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

0

doomed = clean

About to be lost — grabbing it is clean AND clever. → Artefacts, no scar. Publish for Reputation, or Sell for Cash, no disrepute.

ANCIENT · THE PAPER

The Sky Drawings

Nazca, c.500 AD

Record only

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

8

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

PREHISTORIC · THE PAPER

The Long Winter

Hiawatha, c.12,800 BP

Record only

Mystery tier 4 · Unknown

REPUTATION

10

published

PLUNDER SCAR

-0

integrity

Pure knowledge — nothing to take. Record → your Data zone; a Historian Publishes it later for the Reputation.

PREHISTORIC · THE PAPER

The Red Deer People

Yunnan, c.14,000 BP

Doomed — grab clean

Mystery tier 3 · Lost

REPUTATION

9

published

SELL

14¢

+0 disrep.

PLUNDER SCAR

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doomed = clean

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